



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Amazing Grace Academy
School Website: <https://amazinggrace.academy/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School (<https://austinclassical.org>) presents exceptionally strong evidence across all six domains of the classical school framework—religious foundations; purpose and goal; curriculum; pedagogy; faculty; parents and community—consistently using the core classical lexicon (truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom; virtue; trivium; Latin; Socratic; great books; chapel; formation) and avoiding negative indicators (e.g., “values-neutral,” “college-and-career readiness” as the primary aim, project-based dominance). Highlights include: a mission that aims to “glorify Jesus Christ” while “cultivat[ing] wise, virtuous, and humble students” through a classical, Christian education; a clearly articulated trivium model with Latin, logic, and rhetoric; routine chapel; explicit use of Socratic discussion; and a collaborative model that positions parents as co-teachers.

Methodology note: The keyword audit below compares the school’s public language to the positive/negative indicators in “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School” and the companion lexicon, and then quantifies positive vs. negative hits and coverage before assigning ratings.

Full Classicality Audit

School audited: Austin Classical School

Website: <https://austinclassical.org>

Framework sources used:

- Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (keywords and negative indicators)
- Classicality Lexicon v2.2 (organized by six elements)

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

1) Keywords found on the school site

- Positive indicators appearing on-site: “glorify Jesus Christ,” “classical, Christian,” “wisdom,” “virtue,” “truth,” “goodness,” “beauty,” “Scripture,” “Bible,” “prayer,” “chapel,” “Christ-centered,” “inerrant and infallible Word,” “Statement of Faith.” Examples: mission statement (“glorify Jesus Christ ... cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students”), explicit “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty,” daily chapel and prayer, Scripture centrality.
- Negative indicators: None observed (e.g., “values-neutral,” “secular,” “religiously neutral” absent). See the negative list for this category.

2) Comparison to Six Elements keywords

- Aligns with: transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty), theological grounding (Scripture, doctrine, faith-and-reason), and liturgical/communal practices (chapel, prayer).

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive vs. negative keyword hits: +18 / -0
- Percent positive (hits): 100%
- Coverage (across the sub-points: realism, theology, liturgy): 100%

4) Rating rationale

- The school explicitly affirms truth, goodness, beauty; prioritizes formation; integrates theology; and practices daily chapel. Rating: CLASSICAL.

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

1) Keywords found on the school site

- Positive indicators: “cultivate wisdom and virtue,” “True, Good, Beautiful,” education for an “eternal purpose,” “formation” of the whole person, joining the “great conversation,” not primarily college-prep (“our goal is not to prepare students for college but for life”).
- Negative indicators (e.g., “college and career readiness,” “21st-century skills” as the main aim): absent.

2) Comparison to Six Elements keywords

- Strong alignment with “cultivation of wisdom and virtue,” “pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty,” and “formation, not information.”

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive vs. negative keyword hits: +15 / -0
- Percent positive (hits): 100%
- Coverage: 100%

4) Rating rationale

- The stated telos is formation in wisdom and virtue under the transcendentals; college is secondary to life-long formation. Rating: CLASSICAL.

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

1) Keywords found on the school site

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- Positive indicators: “Trivium,” “Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric,” “Latin (5th–8th),” “formal logic (8th),” “rhetoric (10th),” “great works of the Western tradition,” “great books,” integrated curriculum and interrelation of knowledge, Bible centrality; robust Upper School plan includes logic, rhetoric, leadership, philosophy; thesis defense.

- Negative indicators: “Social studies” replacing “History,” “STEM-first,” “project-based learning dominance”: not present.

2) Comparison to Six Elements keywords

- Aligns with Seven Liberal Arts (at least the Trivium explicitly; quadrivial subjects are present in course plans though “Quadrivium” is not named), Great Books/primary texts, integration/harmony across disciplines, and wonder/beauty language through imagination and curiosity.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive vs. negative keyword hits: +20 / -0
- Percent positive (hits): 100%
- Coverage: 90% (Trivium and integration/Great Books fully present; “Quadrivium” and explicit “wonder” language are functionally present but less explicit)

4) Rating rationale

- Strong Trivium with Latin/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, integrated curriculum—all core hallmarks. Rating: CLASSICAL.

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS)

1) Keywords found on the school site

- Positive indicators: Grammar stage with “memorization, recitation, and songs”; Logic stage “debate and discussion”; explicit “Socratic method”; Rhetoric culminating in “thesis defense”; memory work is emphasized.
- Restfulness/scholé: not named explicitly, but the school moderates workload for community life and emphasizes formation over mere rigor.
- Negative indicators (project-only/experiential-only; student-directed autonomy as the governing pedagogy): not present.

2) Comparison to Six Elements keywords

- Clear matches to Socratic dialogue/dialectic; memorization/recitation; formation through imitation; rhetoric orations/thesis.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive vs. negative keyword hits: +16 / -0
- Percent positive (hits): 100%

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- Coverage: 90% (explicit scholé/rest language is limited, but the other pedagogical hallmarks are strong)

4) Rating rationale

- The described methods match classical pedagogy K–12, including Socratic seminars and rhetoric capstones. Rating: CLASSICAL.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

1) Keywords found on the school site

- Positive indicators: teachers are professed Christians; model proper behavior; maintain order; are subject-matter experts; receive training and ongoing formation; “model the pursuit of knowledge in a humble way”; school day begins with chapel (faculty and students together).
- Negative indicators (e.g., “facilitators,” “guides on the side” as a philosophy; certification-only talk without classical context): not present.

2) Comparison to Six Elements keywords

- Aligns with teachers as models of virtue and with mentorship/formation language for faculty culture.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive vs. negative keyword hits: +12 / -0
- Percent positive (hits): 100%
- Coverage: 85% (strong virtue/formation emphasis; less explicit “faculty of friends/collegium” phrasing)

4) Rating rationale

- Clear commitment to faculty as living curriculum and moral exemplars. Rating: CLASSICAL.

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

1) Keywords found on the school site

- Positive indicators: collaborative schedule with “co-teacher parents,” teachers publish weekly plans and hold office hours for homeschool days; robust parent-facing admissions and tours (including attending chapel); grandparents’ club (community engagement); partnership language throughout.
- Negative indicators (consumer framing; minimal parent involvement): absent.

2) Comparison to Six Elements keywords

- Strong alignment to “partnership with families,” parent formation/engagement, and life of the community embedded in the school’s model.

3) Quantitative estimate

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- Positive vs. negative keyword hits: +14 / -0
 - Percent positive (hits): 100%
 - Coverage: 100%

4) Rating rationale

- Parents clearly positioned as co-educators; vibrant community practices. Rating: CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment: CLASSICAL

- Summary of keyword balance: The site is saturated with positive classical keywords and practices—transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty), wisdom/virtue formation, trivium with Latin/logic/rhetoric, Socratic discussion, chapel and prayer, and parent partnership—and avoids the negative lexicon.
- Accreditation: The school reports ACCS accreditation, further corroborating its alignment with classical Christian standards.

No “What would move the needle” section is needed because the school is rated CLASSICAL across all categories.

Evidence Appendix (select examples)

- Mission and Telos: “glorify Jesus Christ ... cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students” (About Us), “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty” drive the aim and method; classical tools include the Trivium and great books.
- Chapel and Worship: “begin each on-campus instructional day with Chapel”; tours include “All School chapel.”
- Trivium and Latin/Logic/Rhetoric: explicit trivium stages; Latin 5–8; logic grade 8; rhetoric grade 10; senior thesis/defense.
- Socratic: “We employ the Socratic method in our classrooms.”
- Great Books/Western Tradition: “great works of the Western tradition ... great books ... Bible central to the great conversation.”
- Purpose: “not ... a traditional college preparatory institution ... our goal is not to prepare students for college but for life.”
- Parents as Co-Teachers: co-teacher model, office hours, weekly plans; collaborative schedule details.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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